

Post-incident review PIR-2025-052

Data Warehouse: degraded latency

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 17 September 2025, Data Warehouse experienced degraded latency in production (US West) for about 75 minutes. A developer in another team noticed their integration tests failing against the service. Investigation found that a gateway routing rule was updated to send traffic to a new backend pool that had not been warmed up.

Impact

Users of Data Warehouse saw degraded latency for about 75 minutes. The service owner, Data Platform, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:08 First signal received.
- 09:30 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:45 Likely cause identified.
- 10:14 Mitigation applied.
- 10:51 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that a gateway routing rule was updated to send traffic to a new backend pool that had not been warmed up.

All traffic depended on one component with no standby.

It took time to work out which team owned the affected component.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Assign a named owner for the component in the service catalogue.
- Add a synthetic probe that exercises the affected path every minute.
- Review alert thresholds so the alert only fires when action is needed.